15 off his ten overs and picked up two wickets. He caught and bowled Sehwag for 23 and then had me caught by Collingwood at point for 50. It was an extraordinary spell that undid our good start. At this point Yuvraj was getting increasingly restless in the dressing room and I remember saying to him that it had to be his day. It was now his responsibility to finish the innings off with a flourish and make sure that we did not squander the early advantage. Yuvraj and Rahul went on to bat beautifully to take us to 250 at the end of our innings, but we still felt we were 20 runs short.

The England innings started well for us with an incredible piece of fielding by Mohammad Kaif. Nick Knight, the left-handed opening batsman, had played the ball off the back foot and was running a quick single when Kaif swooped in from cover to pick up the ball and dived full-length to break the wicket. England were 6–1 and we had an early breakthrough. It was an excellent piece of athleticism from one of our best fielders.

We picked up Marcus Trescothick, the other opener, when he mistimed a pull off Zaheer and ended up giving me an easy catch at backward square. It was then that Ashish Nehra took over. It was easily the best I have seen Ashish bowl and he looked a man possessed that night in Durban. He was getting the ball to move both ways and was bowling at speeds between 140 and 145 kph, making it extremely difficult for the England batsmen to negotiate his pace and swing. It must be one of the best spells of fast bowling by an Indian bowler in a limited-over international. By the thirtieth over England were eight wickets down with more than 140 runs still required. Rahul, who was keeping wicket in that tournament, and Sehwag took some good catches off Ashish's bowling and the whole team was fired up. We could sense we were knocking on the door of the Super Six stage.

India eventually won the match by 82 runs. It was now a question of sustaining the momentum for the rest of the tournament. This time there were great celebrations back home and India were suddenly the team to beat in the competition. While Durban had set us on course, our next match against Pakistan was just massive. It was one of the most high-pressure cricket matches I have played in and had enormous significance for our fans back home. Without doubt it was the match of the World Cup.